

DIANELA ESPINOZA

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[Github](#)

Economist with experience in rigorous econometric methods such as regression discontinuity design, propensity score matching, and multivariable regression with fixed effects—to evaluate large-scale interventions. Strong skills in survey design, fieldwork coordination, and statistical programming (Stata, Python, R). Led Data Analysis team coordinating 1,126 volunteers from 11 regions to deliver 13,232 tutoring hours to 700 vulnerable students in rural areas. Completing an MPA in Data Science for Public Policy at LSE.

Research interests: Development Economics, Education Policy, Early Childhood Development, Impact Evaluation.

EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND

London School of Economics and Political Science (LSE)

2025 - 2027

MPA in Data Science for Public Policy.

- **Data Science for Public Policy:** Supervised learning (Lasso, Ridge and Elastic Net regression, logistic regression, decision trees); unsupervised learning (K-means, hierarchical clustering); text classification; cross-validation techniques.
- **Python packages:** pandas, numpy, statsmodels, scikit-learn, xgboost, nltk, spacy.
- Recipient of a full competitive scholarship from the School of Public Policy.
- Visiting Fellow at the Freedom and Prosperity Centre, London School of Economics (LSE).

University of Piura (UDEP)

2018 - 2022

Bachelor's Degree in Economics.

GPA: 17.34/20. (US GPA: 4/4). Rank: 5/45

- **Teaching Assistant for undergraduate level:** Delivered instructional support across multiple economics courses: Development and Environment, Antitrust and Regulation, Microeconomics, Short-term Macroeconomics, Economic Optimization 1, and Statistics 1.
- **Research Assistant:** Built algorithms to scrape information from web pages with Python, and used Stata to clean the data. This process allowed me to systematize around one million data.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University College London (UCL)

2026 - Present

Research collaboration with Professor Gabriella Conti (Department of Economics).

Research Assistant

- **Data management and analysis:** Managed and cleaned endline data and conducted statistical analysis in Stata, contributing to reports, presentations, and policy outputs.
- **Stakeholder coordination:** Coordinated with stakeholders during the endline stage of the study to ensure alignment across partners and smooth implementation.
- **Data collection:** Coordinated the data collection team throughout the endline stage, supporting fieldwork logistics and data quality.

Group for the Analysis of Development (GRADE)

2022 - 2025

Leading think tank in LATAM on social studies since 1980.

Quantitative Research Assistant

- **Impact evaluation and policy analysis:** Programmed and conducted analyses using R and Stata on the short-term impacts of Jornada Escolar Completa, a programme aimed at enhancing student learning outcomes by increasing classroom hours (submitted to Journal of Human Resources).
- **Data cleaning and fieldwork coordination:** Conducted data cleaning in Stata for Round 7 of the Young Lives Study in Peru and led enumerator training for the History of Education module, a key component of this unique study that documents participants' complete educational trajectories, from pre-school to higher education.

Innovations for Poverty Action (IPA - Peru)

2021 - 2022

International research and policy advocacy organisation founded by the distinguished economist Dean Karlan.

Research Intern

- **Impact evaluation design:** Co-developed theories of change for evaluations of programmes addressing the gender gap in STEM careers in Belize and intercultural bilingual pre-school education in Peru, contributing to rigorous programme design.
- **Programming and quality assurance:** Programmed and supervised data collection through SurveyCTO, monitoring survey progress and ensuring data quality. Cleaned and systematized databases in Stata for analysis.
- **Survey implementation and training:** Led training of enumerators, auditors, and back-checkers on survey protocols and IRB compliance standards.

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Growing JUNTOS: Long-Term Impacts of Peru's Conditional Cash Transfer Programme on Human Capital

Ongoing

(Working paper - Under review at *Economic Development and Cultural Change*)

- Evaluated whether Peru's conditional cash transfer programme (JUNTOS) impacts long-term human capital and family formation outcomes using propensity score matching on longitudinal data (2006-2023) from 2,000+ Young Lives participants.
- Designed propensity score matching methodology to evaluate secondary school completion, higher education transition, labor market entry, and early parenthood at age 22.

First years of life and El Niño Phenomenon in Peru: Impact on Early Childhood Development

2022

(Bachelor Thesis)

- Evaluated the impact of the 2017 El Niño Phenomenon on Early Childhood Development in Peru.
- Conducted extensive literature review on early childhood indicators, climatic shocks, and human capital formation.
- Systematized and cleaned data from multiple modules of the Demographic and Family Health Survey (DHS) and climatological data from the University of Delaware to assess effects on human development.

PUBLICATIONS

Book

- Cueto, S., Rojas, V., Espinoza, D., Campos, A., & Curi, K. (2025). *¿Qué hemos aprendido del estudio longitudinal Niños del Milenio en el Perú? Nuevos hallazgos y desafíos pendientes (2018-2025)*. Lima: GRADE, Group for the Analysis of Development. [\[Link\]](#)

Policy Briefs

- Cueto, S., & Espinoza, D. (2025). Education and Learning: Preliminary Findings from the 2023–24 Young Lives Survey (Round 7): Peru. *Young Lives Factsheet*, University of Oxford. [\[Link\]](#)

AWARDS, HONORS AND FELLOWSHIPS

- **2026:** LSE-Freedom Prosperity Centre Fellow, selected from over 200 outstanding School of Public Policy students.
- **2025:** Peruvian Scholarship for Public Service at LSE (1 of 6 awarded to Peruvian students).
- **2025:** Half scholarship for Lima Summer School 2025 programme.
- **2021:** Winning team in international competition on Free Market and Anticompetitive Practices (best of 23 teams, LATAM and Spain).
- **2021:** Scholarship for Professional Specialization Programme in Economics and Finance.
- **2021:** PRONABEC scholarship supporting vulnerable students affected by pandemic.
- **2018:** Scholarship from UDEP (2018-2022) for undergraduate Economics studies (1 of 2 awarded nationally).

CONFERENCES

- **2024:** “Speaker at the IX National Seminar - Tarapoto”, organized by the Peruvian Society of Educational Research (SIEP). I presented the preliminary results of my working paper: Growing JUNTOS: Long-Term Impacts of Peru's Conditional Cash Transfer Programme on Human Capital.

COMPLEMENTARY EDUCATION

Lima Summer School in Economics <i>University of Piura and University of British Columbia.</i>	2025
Global Policy Analysis Course. <i>University of Zurich</i>	2024
Designing and Running Randomized Evaluations Course. <i>Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT)</i>	2024
Impact evaluation methodologies for social programmes. <i>Group of Analysis for the Development (GRADE)</i>	2024
Behavioral Economics for Better Public Policies - Issue 7 <i>Inter-American Development Bank (IDB)</i>	2021
Designing a Multidimensional Poverty Index <i>United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) and Oxford Poverty and Human Development Initiative (OPHI)</i>	2021

EXTRACURRICULAR INFORMATION

- **IT skills:** Excel, Stata, R, Python, Latex, GitHub, SurveyCTO, KoboToolbox, Qualtrics.
- **Languages:** Spanish: Native Speaker; English: Advanced.
- **Leadership:** Leader in Data Analytics Area in the educational volunteering “Yachay Wasi”.
- Secretary, Peruvian Society at LSE, Board 2025-2026.

REFERENCES

Alan Sánchez
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